Our Marine artillery and one ship off shore at Beirut returned fire of Druse artillery in the hills and silenced it. F-14's from the *Eisenhower* had flown a reconnaissance mission. I called the colonel in command. He said morale was high.

Sept. 10

Met with George Shultz. . . . Our main meeting was on Lebanon. The situation is worsening. We may be facing a choice of getting out or enlarging our mission. Chiefs of Staff want to send the *New Jersey*. I'm concerned as to whether that won't have a bad morale effect on our friends in Central America. We're going to move her through the canal and offshore to the Atlantic before seeing whether she should head for Lebanon.

Sept. 11

N.S.C. is meeting . . . on Lebanon re a new cable from Bud McFarlane. Troops obviously P.L.O. and Syrian have launched a new attack against the Lebanese Army. Our problem is do we expand our mission to aid the Lebanese army with artillery and air support? This could be seen as putting us in the war.

George Shultz, Bill Casey and Jim Baker have just left me at 2 p.m. to get more info on what is happening and where our partners in the M.N.F. [multinational force] stand. Contingent on what they learn I've ordered use of naval gun fire. My reasoning is that this can be explained as protection of our Marines hoping it might signal the Syrians to pull back. I don't think they want a war with us. If it doesn't work then we'll have to decide between pulling out or going to the Congress and making a case for greater involvement. N.S.C. will meet again at 6 p.m.

The meeting [was held and] didn't change anything so I've called for use of Navy fire power and air strikes